

CHINA METALS & MINING

China coal sector – assessing potential impact to industry production and prices post recent accident

On the evening of May 22nd, a major gas explosion incident took place in Liushenyu Coal Mine in Changzhi City, Shanxi Province, resulting in significant casualties and suspension of the impacted mines for safety inspections ([link](#)). The Liushenyu Coal Mine, operated by the Shanxi Tongzhou Group, has an annual production capacity of 1.2mnt of hard coking coal.

According to Mysteel data, currently total coal capacity suspended for safety inspections following the accident has reached 125mnt (annual) raw ore in Shanxi or 113 coal mines, while 16 coal mines that were previously suspended related to the incident have been restarted. Among the currently suspended mines, the reported data indicated nearly 80 mnt or 64% of the suspended coal output are expected to remain offline for at least one month or do not yet have a clear restart timeline. Nearly all affected coal production capacity relates to met coal, which we estimate is equivalent to 60mnt of commercial coal annual capacity, representing more than 10% of the domestic met coal market.

While the situation remains fluid and uncertain and we take no view on the supply recovery timelines, we see risk to Chinese coal production in the coming months due to potentially tightened safety control. Following several domestic coal mine accidents in 2H23, China started a three-year production safety act plan (安全生产治本攻坚三年行动方案), which led to production decline across key coal output regions in subsequent months. As a result, domestic thermal coal pricing moved up by 27% and met coal pricing by 30% during that period.

Fundamentals of the coal sector have been improving, with rising demand from coal chemical production, lower imports, and early restocking by IPPs in May ([China monthly monitor in May](#)). As a result, thermal coal spot prices have moved up from Rmb718/t to Rmb835/t since CNY, counter to normal seasonality. We see potential upside risk to prices in the coming months depending on the impact of supply disruptions following the accident.

For context, we estimate for each 10% increase in domestic spot prices, earnings would move up by 4.1% for Shenhua, 7.8% for Chinacoal, and 4.0% for Yankuang. We maintain BUY on Chinacoal A/H.

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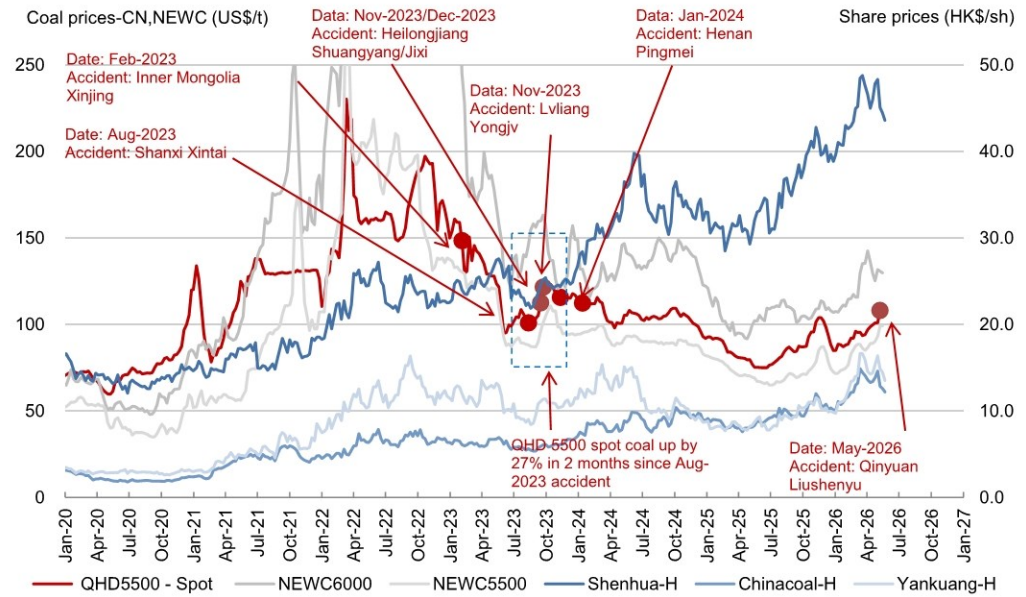
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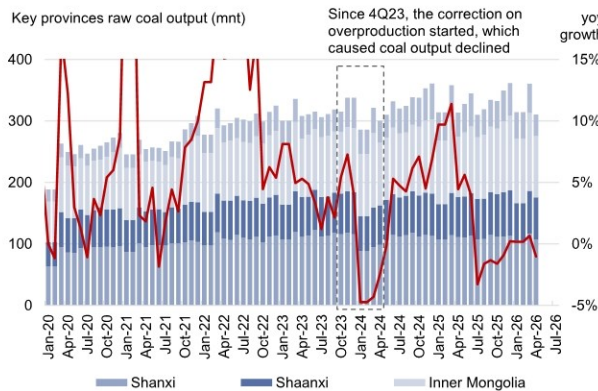
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Exhibit 1: Recent year coal accidents impacted domestic spot prices as safety measures constrained supply in the subsequent months



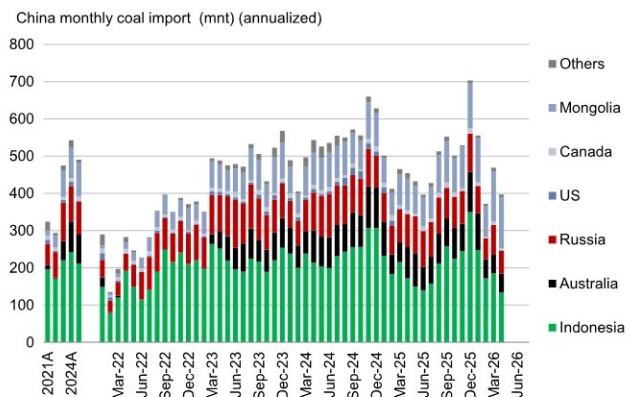
Source: Mysteel, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: The start of a 3-year safety act (安全生产治本攻坚战三年行动方案) following the accidents in 2H23 led to a period of production decline for major coal producing regions

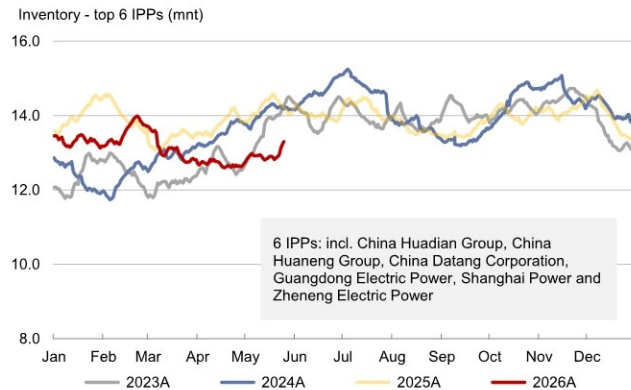


Source: NBS, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

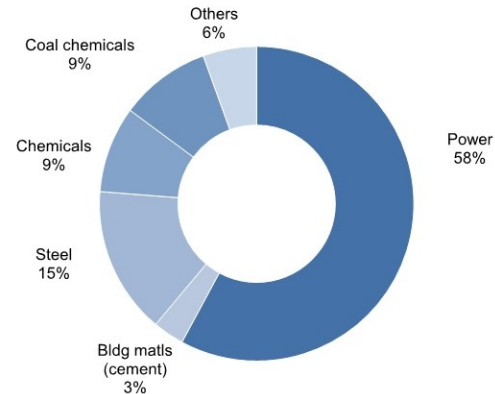
Exhibit 3: Monthly china coal imports declined in 2026 YTD by an average of 43mnt versus 2025A



Source: China Customs, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Coal inventories at the top 6 IPPs were below normal seasonalities as of May-2026

Source: Fenwei, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Coal chemical consumed 9% of total coal consumption in China in 2025A

Source: Wind, CEIC, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Valuation peers –Coal

Company	Ticker	Rating	Target	Price	ccy	Mkt cap	PE		PB		ROE		EV/EBITDA		FCF yield		Div yield		Perf.
Price as of 26-May-2026				Local		US\$ bn	26E	27E	26E	27E	26E	27E	26E	27E	26E	27E	26E	27E	YTD
China Shenhua Energy	1088.HK	Neutral	40.00	44.50	HKD	116.7	13.4	13.1	1.9	1.8	14%	14%	7.1	7.0	6%	6%	6%	6%	12%
Yankuang Energy	1171.HK	Neutral	12.50	13.82	HKD	17.7	10.6	12.5	1.5	1.5	15%	12%	6.4	6.3	10%	13%	6%	5%	42%
China Coal Energy	1898.HK	Buy	16.00	12.45	HKD	21.1	7.9	7.1	0.8	0.8	11%	11%	4.5	3.8	7%	16%	5%	5%	23%
Average for HK coal peers							10.6	10.9	1.4	1.4	13%	13%	6.0	5.7	8%	12%	5%	5%	26%
China Shenhua Energy	601088.SS	Neutral	41.00	44.80	CNY	135.6	15.5	15.2	2.2	2.1	14%	14%	8.3	8.1	5%	6%	5%	5%	11%
Yankuang Energy	600188.SS	Neutral	16.00	20.65	CNY	30.5	18.3	21.6	2.7	2.6	15%	12%	8.2	8.2	7%	9%	3%	3%	57%
China Coal Energy	601898.SS	Buy	21.00	15.40	CNY	30.1	11.3	10.1	1.2	1.1	11%	11%	6.1	5.3	5%	12%	3%	4%	24%
Zhengzhou Coal	600121.SS	NC	NA	4.02	CNY	0.7	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	-2%
Shanxi Lanhua	600123.SS	NC	NA	6.27	CNY	1.4	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	6%
Yangquan Coal	600348.SS	NC	NA	8.97	CNY	4.8	13.6	12.3	0.9	0.8	6%	6%	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	10%
Guizhou Panjiang	600395.SS	NC	NA	5.19	CNY	1.6	16.7	14.8	1.0	1.0	6%	6%	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	2%	3%	15%
Anhui Hengyuan Coal	600971.SS	NC	NA	7.30	CNY	1.3	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	19%
Kailuan Energy	600997.SS	NC	NA	5.24	CNY	1.2	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	-7%
Shanxi Lu'an	601699.SS	NC	NA	14.35	CNY	6.3	12.3	11.5	0.9	0.9	7%	7%	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	24%
Pingdingshan Coal	601666.SS	NC	NA	7.22	CNY	2.6	13.9	12.2	0.7	0.7	5%	6%	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	4%	5%	-1%
Datong Coal	601001.SS	NC	NA	17.17	CNY	4.2	11.1	10.7	1.4	1.3	11%	11%	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	4%	4%	29%
Henan Shenhua	000933.SZ	NC	NA	30.14	CNY	10.0	8.0	7.7	2.3	2.0	29%	25%	4.4	3.7	n.a.	n.a.	6%	6%	17%
Jizhong Energy	000937.SZ	NC	NA	5.38	CNY	2.8	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	1%
Shanxi Xishan	000983.SZ	NC	NA	6.40	CNY	5.3	13.6	12.8	0.9	0.9	7%	7%	4.7	4.1	n.a.	n.a.	3%	3%	2%
Huolinhe Coal	002128.SZ	NC	NA	29.11	CNY	9.6	11.1	10.6	1.5	1.4	14%	13%	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	3%	3%	11%
Gansu Jingyuan Coal	000552.SZ	NC	NA	2.64	CNY	2.1	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	15%
IM Yitai-B	900948.SS	NC	NA	2.70	USD	7.9	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	47%
Average for China coal peers							13.2	12.7	1.4	1.3	11%	11%	6.3	5.9	6%	9%	4%	4%	15%

Notes: NC = Not Covered where estimates for NC stocks are based on consensus numbers; target prices are based on a 12-month timeframe

Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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